Baptized into Christ

Matthew 28:18-20; Romans 6:3-4 (KJV)

Scripture

Matthew 28:18-20

18 And Jesus came and spake unto them, saying, All power is given unto me in heaven and in earth.

19 Go ye therefore, and teach all nations, baptizing them in the name of the Father, and of the Son, and of the Holy Ghost: 20 Teaching them to observe all things whatsoever I have commanded you: and, lo, I am with you alway, even unto the end of the world. Amen.

Romans 6:3-4

3 Know ye not, that so many of us as were baptized into Jesus Christ were baptized into his death? 4 Therefore we are buried with him by baptism into death: that like as Christ was raised up from the dead by the glory of the Father, even so we also should walk in newness of life.

Outline

1. Commanded by Christ for his disciples

Baptize them in the name of the Father, and of the Son, and of the Holy _____.

Christians baptize because _____ commanded it.

Read: Matthew 28:18-20; Acts 2:41; Acts 8:12

2. Baptized into Christ's death and resurrection

So many of us as were baptized into Jesus Christ were baptized into his _____.

Baptism speaks of our _____ with Christ.

Read: Romans 6:3-4; Galatians 3:27; Colossians 2:12

3. Baptism: God's gift through water and the Word

Baptism is not simply water, but water joined with God's _____.

Faith _____ the gift God gives in baptism.

Read: Mark 16:16; Titus 3:5; Acts 2:38-39; 1 Peter 3:21

Discussion questions

1. What do all Christians agree about baptism, according to today's passages?

2. What do Lutherans mean by calling baptism a "means of grace"?

3. What does Romans 6 say baptism should mean for the way we live this week?

4. How can we hold our own convictions about baptism while showing love to Christians who practise it differently?

This week

Each morning this week, as you wash your face, remember your baptism, as Luther suggested: thank God that you belong to him, confess your sins, and rise to live the new life he gives.